Eric Nguyen

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Education

University of California, Irvine — Irvine, CA
B.S. Computer Engineering — *Expected June 2029*
- Transferring from Orange Coast College (Fall 2027)

Orange Coast College — Costa Mesa, CA
A.S. Computer Science — *Aug 2023 – May 2027*
- GPA: 3.72 | Joseph R. Kroll Award, Garrison Fellow, Student Leader of the Year (2025)

Work Experience

Product & Solutions Engineer — Midway City, CA
Plethora.so — Software Development Start-up — *April 2024 – Aug 2026*
- Cut a meal-prep client's biweekly menu, label, and cut-sheet processing from **5 hours to 30 minutes (90%)** by shipping Chef Nourish, a production platform (Next.js, TypeScript, PostgreSQL, Vercel), on a 3-engineer team.
- Owned the client engagement from requirements to handoff, turning customer needs into scoped features: import flows, allergen/dietary checks, kitchen terminal, docs.

Operations Assistant & Automation Developer — Costa Mesa, CA
Garrison Honors Center, Orange Coast College — *Jan 2024 – Present*
- Shipped an offline desktop app (Python, PySide6, Pydantic, pyodbc/MS Access) automating eligibility checks for 17 honor societies, replacing manual review of **300+ applications per semester**.
- Wrote the Python logic that parses HTML transcripts with Beautiful Soup and recomputes GPA/units to check 148 requirements for 17 societies.
- Wrote results back to the registrar's 20-year-old Access database, previewing every update so no record was overwritten.

Projects

SLAP! — Live-Caption Classroom Device, Hardware & Software — OCC Hacks 2026, Orange Coast College
TypeScript, Node (Hono, WebSockets), React Router, Postgres, Deepgram, ESP32-S3 — *Oct 2026*
- Built an ESP32-S3 device streaming lecture audio over WebSockets for **live captions in ∼120 ms** in 2 languages.
- Turned each transcript into notes, spaced-repetition flashcards, and a per-student study plan with OpenAI's GPT-Luna.
- Benchmarked 3 translation backends, picking one with a 167 ms median for both languages.

OCC Hacks 2026 — Hackathon Website — Orange Coast College | occhacks.com
Next.js, React, TypeScript, Tailwind, Supabase (Postgres, Auth, RLS), Resend, PostHog — *May 2026 – Oct 2026*
- Solo-built the sign-up and organizer platform: **1,400+ unique visitors**, 12,000+ page views, 160+ applications in 7 weeks.
- Kept 93% of applicants who cleared the first form step through to submission; sessions averaged 12 minutes.

LLM Math Reasoning — Fine-Tuning Research — Giles T. Brown Research Symposium
AI Research Fellow | LoRA fine-tuning, 4-bit quantization, dataset curation — *Jan 2025 – April 2025*
- Fine-tuned DeepSeek-R1-Distill-Qwen-7B (4-bit) with LoRA on a single RTX 4060 Ti, **raising AIME 2024 accuracy from 46.7% to 53.3%** over the base model on a curated math reasoning dataset.
- Built a 137-problem GSM8K/AIME/Putnam training set of verified step-by-step solutions using Qwen2.5-32B-Instruct.

Leadership

Founder & President — Costa Mesa, CA
Iota Xi, Orange Coast College — *Feb 2024 – May 2026*
- Founded Iota Xi, OCC's first computer science honor society; partnered with Amazon, Sony, Kickstarter, and NASA.

Lead Organizer — Costa Mesa, CA
Spookathon 2025, HackCC 2024 — *Feb 2024 – Feb 2025*
- Directed a 6-department team across multiple colleges to run two 30-hour hackathons; **raised over $21,000** in sponsorship and secured venue, catering, mentors, and accommodations for 100+ attendees per event; won OCC's Event of the Year.

Treasurer, Academic Honor Societies — Costa Mesa, CA
Phi Theta Kappa, Alpha Beta Gamma, Mu Alpha Theta — *Aug 2025 – May 2026*
- Managed a **∼$90K budget** across PTK, ABG, and MAT to support scholarships, conferences, and chapter events.

Skills

Languages: TypeScript, JavaScript, Python, C++, SQL, HTML/CSS
Frontend: React, Next.js, React Router, Tailwind CSS, shadcn/ui
Backend & Data: Node.js, Next.js, Hono, WebSockets, PostgreSQL, Supabase, Neon
Hardware & Tools: ESP32-S3, Arduino, Git, Docker, Vercel, PostHog